

# THE EVOLUTION OF THE AI MARKET: 2022-2025.

From magic to ROI accountability in three years — four distinct phases with different behaviours, expectations and risks for anyone selling AI solutions.

MARKET MATURITY PHASES

### 2022

BIG BANG

ChatGPT launched. Market enchanted by the "magic chat." Little real enterprise application — more entertainment than value.

ENCHANTMENT

### 2023

PROLIFERATION

GPT-4, Llama and Claude launched. Samsung leak. Internal pilots formalised. Race for tools begins.

EXPANSION

### 2024

ACCOUNTABILITY

Market complains about results. CFOs audit projects. First failure studies gain mainstream traction.

SCEPTICISM

### 2025

ROI CRISIS

MIT: 95% fail. PWC: 56% of CEOs with no result. Deloitte: only 20% with revenue uplift. Current phase.

STRUCTURAL DEMAND

1 WHAT DEFINES EACH PHASE

### 2022

BIG BANG

Public conversational LLM. Individual experimentation with no structured AI budget.

### 2023

PROLIFERATION

Multiple competitive models, formalised pilots. Race for tools, first budgets committed.

### 2024

ACCOUNTABILITY

Executive pressure for measurable return. Project audits and contract cancellations without visible ROI.

### 2025

ROI CRISIS

Research confirms systemic failure. Stack consolidation, governance and ISO now mandatory.

2 WHAT TRIGGERED EACH TRANSITION

2022 → 2023

GPT-4 and open-source models — quality leap forced companies to formalise pilots. Samsung leak accelerated the governance data debate.

2023 → 2024

Accumulation of pilots with no result — dozens of internal projects never reached production. CFOs began questioning AI budget lines with no demonstrable return.

2024 → 2025

Publication of failure studies — MIT (95%), PWC (56%), Deloitte (20% revenue) turned individual scepticism into a consolidated market narrative.

3 WHAT TO DO IN EACH PHASE — SELLER'S PERSPECTIVE

#### 2022 — BIG BANG

Educate the market and plant seeds with stakeholders who will return once budget is approved.

#### 2023 — PROLIFERATION

Build technical differentiators and capture first clients. Early movers with something that works create learning lock-in.

#### 2024 — ACCOUNTABILITY

Present documented ROI before every sales meeting. Clients without results are cancelling contracts.

#### 2025 — ROI CRISIS

Position with governance, ISO and vertical domain expertise. The market is paying for security and proven results.

4 HOW TO DETECT WHICH PHASE A CLIENT IS IN

#### EARLY-PHASE SIGNALS

- Talks about "testing AI" with no specific use case
- Budget undefined, decision driven by enthusiasm
- Asks about features, not about ROI
- References a LinkedIn post or podcast

#### ACCOUNTABILITY / CRISIS SIGNALS

- Asks for success cases with concrete metrics
- Mentions a previous project that "didn't work"
- Requires GDPR, ISO 27001 or SLA before moving on
- CFO or legal in the first meeting

#### ADVANCED MATURITY SIGNALS

- In-house AI engineer evaluating the solution
- Requests logs, observability and audit trail
- Compares per-token vs. per-outcome pricing
- Wants stack integration, not another tool

5 HISTORICAL MILESTONES AND THEIR MARKET EFFECTS

| YEAR | EVENT                                  | IMMEDIATE EFFECT                                     | LESSON FOR THE SELLER                                   |
|------|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 2022 | ChatGPT launch (Nov)                   | Explosion of interest; first enterprise tests        | Education window — plant before harvesting              |
| 2023 | GPT-4, Samsung leak, Llama open source | Race for tools; shadow AI proliferates               | Technical differentiation has value; governance matters |
| 2024 | Failure reports (Gartner, Forrester)   | CFOs audit projects; cancellations without ROI       | Documented ROI is a prerequisite, not a differentiator  |
| 2025 | MIT 95%, PWC 56%, Deloitte 66%/20%     | Crisis goes mainstream; ISO and compliance mandatory | Vertical domain + governance = only defensibility       |

We have moved out of the experimentation phase and now the market demands structured returns on every project. **Anyone who has not understood this transition is still selling to 2023.**